3.7 Food Adulteration

Sometimes, things that we buy in the market are mixed with harmful and unwanted substances. It is called adulteration. Food can also get adulterated due to carelessness or lack of proper handling.



We must be careful about the common adulterants in our consumable goods especially in food. Any adulterated food when consumed will be harmful and can be a health hazard.

An adulterated substance will not indicate the true properties of the original substance. For example, used tea leaves are sometimes used as adulterants in tea. Turmeric powder is adulterated with a bright yellow chemical which is poisonous to us.



In most houses people use commercial water filter to remove not only the impurities but also to kill the harmful germs in water using UV rays.

Reverse Osmosis (RO) is a process of removing impurities from water to make it potable.

Activity 8

Collect and share information on common adulterants and their detection in food stuff in the class. Watch the youtube video: 10 simple tricks to find adulterated food. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_XLi WunnudY

Points to Remember

- Matter is anything that has mass and occupies space.
- All matter is made up of extremely small particles called atoms.
- Matter is classified into solids, liquids and gases on the basis of two important factors.
  a. The way the particles are arranged
  b. The way the particles attract each other.
- Difference between the properties of solids, liquids and gases is due to the difference in the arrangement of the particles and the nature of the attractive forces between them.
- A pure substance can be an element or a compound and it can be made up of only one kind of particles.
- A mixture is an impure substance containing two or more components physically mixed in any proportion.
- Separation of mixtures is done
  1. to remove harmful components.
  2. to obtain the useful components.
  3. to obtain a substance in a highly pure form.